

Nathan Turczan

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SUMMARY

Product designer who ships the products he designs. Eight years designing creative software across iOS, iPadOS, macOS, and web—and shipping it end to end, including documentation, development, and testing. I take intricate, workflow-driven problems (real-time harmony, networked performance, pitch correction) and turn them into elegant, direct-manipulation experiences, tested and refined with real users. AI is part of my daily design process: describe, prototype in high fidelity, refine—backed by a knowledge base that compounds. MFA from CalArts; published at NIME. Deep in creative-app craft, from layout and typography to motion and behavior.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Designer - Scale Navigator, LLC 2021 - Present

- Designed, built, and shipped a suite of music-creation tools across web, iOS, Android, macOS/Windows desktop, and DAW plugins (VST3/AU — **Logic Pro compatible**) as the sole designer and developer (project began 2018; incorporated 2021)

Products Shipped:

- Scale Navigator Dashboard** — direct-manipulation instrument for navigating harmonic space (based on Tymoczko's *Geometry of Music*); one source of truth for scale/chord state, broadcast via MIDI and parameter automation (Web, iOS, Android, VST3, AU)
- Ensemble Jammer** — networked multiplayer instruments where the interface guarantees no wrong notes; non-musician to ensemble in under 60 seconds (Web, iOS)
- Tonalign** — real-time MIDI pitch correction; wrong notes become right notes (VST3, AU)
- SNaPS** — scale-aware sampler with three engines (Emitter, Looper, Sequencer); AI sample-ingestion (Spotify's Basic Pitch) auto-tags pitch-class metadata
- NotesChordScales** — real-time chord and scale inference (Web, AU)

Product Manager & Sound Designer - FutureCare 2022 - 2025

- Led product for **Wave of Wellness** (iOS/Android), a React Native wellness dashboard integrating 5+ sensor types (motion, bed, door, medication, air quality); 9 agency partnerships, ~60 active installs
- Iterated on Wave of Wellness UI in **Figma** with UI designer Yeji Li: layout explorations, navigation A/Bs, visual-direction studies
- Shipped a custom **Crestron Home Driver** (published on the Crestron Drivers Portal); coordinated cross-functional teams, ran Agile and pilots

Sound Designer - Output Inc. 2021

- Sound design and kit creation for **Arcade**, Output's flagship subscription instrument

Associate Product Manager - SPG Studios 2020 - 2021

- APM for **Remoto**, cloud ADR software for film/TV post-production; owned milestones and specs

Adjunct Instructor - California Institute of the Arts 2021 - 2022

- Taught Media + Web Development (Music Technology): weekly lectures, live demos, and group critique sessions

Composer & Interaction Designer - Freelance 2018 - Present

- SOULS** (2022) with Sia & David O'Reilly — designed and prototyped the interactive music system for 10,000 digital characters (21-chord vocabulary, constant-power crossfade); #3 on Billboard's digital-collectibles ranking (July 2022), Designboom, Forbes
- Refik Anadol Studio's** *WDCH Dreams* (LA Phil centennial) — sound-file tagging and data prep
- CTO, **Chordas Collective** (vocal-electronic ensemble); Founder, **LA Laptop Orchestra** (participatory music project); scores for iHeartRadio

SKILLS

Design: Product & interaction design, visual design (layout, typography, motion), high-fidelity prototyping in code, design systems, usability testing, Figma

Build: React, TypeScript, Web Audio API, Tone.js, D3.js, Firebase, JUCE/C++, MIDI

Domain: Creative-app & instrument design, music theory, DAW plugins (VST3/AU)

EDUCATION

MFA, Music Technology - California Institute of the Arts 2019

BA, Vocal Performance - UC Santa Cruz 2013

Workshop in Algorithmic Computer Music - UC Santa Cruz (studied directly under David Cope) 2012

SPEAKING & PUBLICATION

Invited Lectures: [Stanford CCRMA](#), [California Institute of the Arts](#), Middlebury College (all 2026)

Publication: Turczan, N. (2019). [The Scale Navigator: A System for Networked Algorithmic Harmony](#). NIME 2019.